Jarrod Tran

AI Product Leader | Enterprise AI, Strategy & Operations

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Summary

AI product leader who takes enterprise AI from pilot to daily use. At Tesla Energy, I built the forward-deployed engineering program and team behind 20+ production AI tools on Claude and Grok, with 1,000+ active users, and the investment model behind $156M in incremental annual profit. Earlier: iPhone India production strategy at Apple, Engineering Operations planning at Waymo, and battery and vehicle programs at Tesla.

Experience

Tesla Energy | Lead, AI Enablement & Factory Strategy

Houston, TX | Aug 2023 to Present

Rejoined Tesla in 2023 after Apple and Waymo.

AI enablement

- Architected Tesla Energy's forward-deployed engineering (FDE) and software engineering program for AI from nothing: deployment model, AI training, architecture (ARB) and security reviews. Hired the first 4, with budget to grow to 15.
- Shipped 20+ production AI tools with 1,000+ active users, built on Claude and Grok models with terminal-based coding tools and tested with user feedback: RAG-based troubleshooting assistants, an internal agent chat, a hiring hub that cut time to hire by 2 weeks, and executive task automations.
- Own the roadmap for a program open to 10,000 eligible employees: rank use cases, assign owners, pair releases with training and weekly adoption reports, and decline any use of personal data.
- Freed an estimated 540 hours per week, worth $1.6M a year, by funding the tools that save the most time.

Strategy and investment

- Built the Python and Tableau model executives used to rank 50+ initiatives for a $23M budget; the funded portfolio delivered $156M in incremental annual profit. Ran MegaUnleash, adding 7.5% California Megapack capacity.
- Redesigned the Megapack investment plan, mitigating $550M in tariff exposure during a 3.2x scale-up. For modules from China, timed foreign-trade zone entry and exit to tariff changes and fast-tracked more zones and exclusions.
- Program Champion for a separate headcount and robotics program that delivered $260M in annualized savings.

Waymo | Strategy & Operations Manager

Mountain View, CA | Oct 2022 to May 2023

- Moved six separately planned functions (hardware, software, fleet, Product, Legal and Engineering) onto one Engineering Operations plan, with shared OKRs, resource plans and reviews for a 200+ person engineering org.
- Replaced manual and emailed reporting with dashboards and automations for fleet health and milestones.

Apple | Strategic Operations Program Manager

Cupertino, CA | Jun 2021 to Jun 2022

- Owned iPhone India production strategy, taking sites in Chennai and Bangalore from greenfield to full-scale production as units grew 293% year over year (4.3M to 16.9M), program revenue rose from $2B to $10B, and exports expanded from 6 to 40+ countries.
- Delayed launch to raise yield, then caught up through other initiatives.

Tesla | Program Manager, Special Projects

Fremont, CA | Jun 2018 to Jun 2021

- Took Project Roadrunner, Tesla's 4680 battery cell program, from pilot to launch readiness through its public unveiling at Tesla's 2020 Battery Day.
- Led Model 3 and Model Y production planning and recovery for two years from launch, ramping each model to 10,000 units per week and hitting every quarterly production and delivery goal.
- Designed and launched Warehouse on Wheels, a platform managing $3.5M per month in operating expenses.

Amazon | Operations Area Manager

Patterson, CA | Mar 2017 to Apr 2018

Education

University at Buffalo | B.S. Business Administration, Finance | Cum Laude